

Accessibility Assessment Plan

Section 1: Purpose of the Audit

This accessibility audit is being conducted to evaluate the Jacksonville Village, Ohio website to ensure it is accessible to all users, including individuals with disabilities. As a public-sector entity, the Village is required under the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Title II to provide equal access to digital services, including its website.

This audit will assess the website against the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 Level AA standard. The goal is to identify accessibility barriers, document findings, and provide recommendations for improvement. This assessment is advisory in nature and does not include any remediation or implementation of fixes.

Section 2: Accessibility Standard Used

This audit will use WCAG 2.1 Level AA as the accessibility standard. WCAG 2.1 Level AA is the accepted benchmark for public-sector website accessibility under ADA Title II requirements.

WCAG is based on four core principles: Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, and Robust (POUR). These principles ensure that content can be accessed and used by individuals with disabilities, including those who rely on assistive technologies such as screen readers or keyboard navigation.

Section 3: Scope of the Audit

In-Scope Content

- Public-facing pages on the Jacksonville Village website
- Homepage and primary navigation pages
- Government and informational pages (e.g., council, departments)
- Public documents such as PDFs (e.g., meeting minutes, reports)
- Forms and contact-related pages

Out-of-Scope Content

- Remediation or fixing of accessibility issues
- Legal certification of compliance
- Third-party systems or external websites not controlled by the Village
- Backend systems or administrative interfaces

This scope ensures the audit is realistic, focused, and aligned with professional accessibility assessment practices.

Section 4: Page Inventory

Page Type	Example URL / Description	Reason for Inclusion
Homepage	https://jacksonvilleoh.com/	Represents overall structure, navigation, and first user experience
News / Minutes	Meeting minutes or announcements pages	Contains frequently accessed public information and documents
Department Page	Government/services pages	Demonstrates how structured content is presented
Contact Page	Contact or forms page	Evaluates form accessibility and user interaction
PDF Document	Linked meeting minutes PDF	Tests document accessibility, a common compliance risk

Section 5: Testing Methodology

Automated Testing Approach

Automated tools such as WAVE, Axe, or similar accessibility scanners will be used to identify common accessibility issues. These tools will help detect problems such as missing alternative text, insufficient color contrast, and structural errors in HTML.

Automated testing allows for efficient identification of baseline issues across multiple pages. However, it has limitations and cannot fully evaluate usability, context, or assistive technology compatibility.

Manual Testing Approach

Manual testing will be conducted to assess accessibility issues that cannot be identified through automated tools. This includes:

- Keyboard-only navigation testing to ensure all features are usable without a mouse
- Evaluation of heading structure and page organization
- Review of link clarity and content readability
- Basic assistive technology considerations, such as screen reader compatibility
- Inspection of forms and interactive elements

Both automated and manual testing are required to provide a complete and accurate accessibility assessment.

Section 6: Evidence Collection Plan

All identified accessibility issues will be documented using clear and consistent evidence. Each finding will include:

- The specific page URL or location of the issue
- A detailed description of the accessibility problem
- Supporting screenshots or tool-generated output
- Reference to the relevant WCAG guideline

All findings will be recorded in the Practicum Findings Log to ensure proper organization, consistency, and traceability throughout the audit process.

Section 7: Professional Constraints & Acknowledgement

This project is conducted as an advisory accessibility assessment only. No remediation or implementation of fixes will be performed.

Students will not directly contact the client, and all work will be reviewed and approved by the instructor before being shared externally. The findings provided are intended to guide improvements and do not constitute legal certification of compliance.